

Psalms 128

Blessed Is Every One That Feareth the Lord

Blessed is every one that feareth the Lord; that walketh in his ways

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *Blessed is every one that feareth the LORD; that walketh in his ways.*
- 2 *For thou shalt eat the labour of thine hands: happy shalt thou be, and it shall be well with thee.*
- 3 *Thy wife shall be as a fruitful vine by the sides of thine house: thy children like olive plants round about thy table.*
- 4 *Behold, that thus shall the man be blessed that feareth the LORD.*
- 5 *The LORD shall bless thee out of Zion: and thou shalt see the good of Jerusalem all the days of thy life.*
- 6 *Yea, thou shalt see thy children's children, and peace upon Israel.*

2 · CONTEXT

Psalms 128 sketches an ordinary, domestic portrait of blessing—productive labor, a flourishing family, long life spent seeing one's own descendants—all traced back to the single root of fearing the Lord and walking in His ways. Its closing benediction ties personal, household blessing directly to the peace and welfare of the whole nation. Henry treats the psalm's plain, unglamorous imagery as deliberate: blessing here is not extraordinary achievement but the quiet, sustained goodness of daily life lived in reverence toward God.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

The psalm opens with a direct declaration: blessed is everyone who fears the Lord and walks in His ways. The blessing described is immediately practical—eating the labor of one's own hands, being happy and prospering—ordinary provision tied directly to a life oriented toward reverence.

Verse 3-4

Family life is pictured warmly: a wife compared to a fruitful vine within the house, children like olive plants gathered around the table. This flourishing household is named explicitly as the blessing belonging to the man who fears the Lord, domestic goodness presented as genuine reward, not incidental.

Verse 5-6

The psalm closes by widening outward: may the Lord bless you out of Zion, may you see the good of Jerusalem all the days of your life, and may you see your children's children—personal blessing extended across generations and tied to communal welfare. The final line is a benediction: peace be upon Israel.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Blessing in this psalm is deliberately ordinary—productive work, a stable household, watching one's family grow across generations—rooted entirely in fearing the Lord and walking in His ways rather than in extraordinary achievement. Personal and domestic flourishing is never treated as separate from the wider community's peace; the two are named together in the psalm's closing lines.

Application for life today.

Notice how this psalm defines blessing through ordinary, daily goods—provision, family, longevity—and let that reshape any tendency to measure your own life only by extraordinary achievement or recognition. If you have a household, let verses 3–4 prompt specific gratitude for the people gathered around your own table, however ordinary that gathering feels most days. Consider how your personal flourishing is tied to your wider community's peace, as verses 5–6 suggest, and let that shape a prayer for both together rather than for your household alone.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. How does this psalm's ordinary picture of blessing—labor, family, longevity—challenge you to measure your own life by something other than extraordinary achievement?

2. What specific gratitude do verses 3–4's images of a fruitful household prompt for the actual people gathered around your table, however ordinary that feels?

3. How does the psalm's closing link between personal blessing and 'the peace upon Israel' (vv. 5–6) shape a prayer for your own household and your wider community together?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).